

The period at the court at Köthen was generally a happy time for Bach, but was marred by family tragedy in 1720. While Bach was accompanying the prince to the spa at Carlsbad, his wife Maria Barbara unexpectedly fell ill and died. He returned too late for the funeral. A year later, Bach married the 20-year-old singer Anna Magdalena Wülcken (see [box](#)).



THE THOMASSCHULE, 1840

Bach lived in Leipzig at the Thomas School, which was affiliated with Thomaskirche, the Lutheran church where he was musical director. This sketch of the school was made by Felix Mendelssohn, who lived in a building opposite from 1835 to 1847. It was Mendelssohn who helped revive interest in Bach's works in the 19th century.

A decisive move to Leipzig

Whether unsettled by these events or by changes at court, the prince married a woman who was utterly uninterested in music,